

Growing up

Young mountains rise up as long as tectonic plates continue to move into each other. The Indian plate is still moving into the Eurasian plate today, at a rate of about 2 in (5 cm) per year, and so the Himalayan mountain range at the boundary is getting higher.

When mountains form, very old rocks that were once buried deep within the Earth surge high above sea level.

Earth's crust thickens and folds to form a mountain range.

Making mountains

Tectonic plates that drift on the surface of the Earth sometimes collide with one another. When this happens, mountains, such as the Himalayas in Asia, are pushed up between them.

The rocks at the edges of continents crumple up and rise, forming mountains.

Mountain

Mountains are found on all continents and at the bottom of every ocean. They may form when two tectonic plates collide or when one plate moves under another one. Mountains don't last forever. It seems odd to imagine a mountain disappearing, but it is happening all the time.